

BIHAR ORIGIN

Sattu Paratha

Roasted Gram Flour Stuffed Flatbread
Bihar's Protein-Packed Everyday Bread

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Sattu Paratha

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Sattu Paratha

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Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Grain That Built Bihar's Summers

Sattu — flour made from roasted Bengal gram, and sometimes barley — holds a place in Bihari life that goes well beyond any single dish. In a region with historically punishing summer heat, sattu became indispensable as both food and medicine: mixed with water and a little salt or sugar, it's a traditional cooling drink believed to combat heatstroke, and ground into flour, it's a cheap, filling, protein-rich staple that doesn't require extensive cooking, making it valuable during the busiest agricultural seasons.

Sattu paratha takes this humble, resourceful ingredient and turns it into a satisfying stuffed flatbread, the roasted gram flour seasoned with pickle, onion, and spices before being encased in whole wheat dough and cooked on a tava until golden. It's a dish that reflects Bihar's broader culinary relationship with sattu — resourceful, deeply nourishing, and born from necessity rather than luxury, much like litti's sattu filling in this same collection.

Where litti requires roasting over coal or in an oven, sattu paratha is a quicker, more everyday version of the same core idea — spiced roasted gram flour wrapped in wheat dough — making it a practical breakfast or lunch that Bihari households can put together with far less time and equipment than its more famous cousin.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Grain That Built Bihar's Summers, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Sattu holds deep cultural significance in Bihar beyond food, historically valued as both a cooling summer drink and an affordable, protein-rich staple. A quicker, more everyday relative of litti, using the same core ingredient in a faster stovetop format. Reflects Bihar's resourceful culinary tradition of building nourishing, satisfying meals from affordable, shelf-stable ingredients. A practical breakfast or lunch dish requiring only a tava, unlike litti's more involved roasting process.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

20m	20m	20m	4
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH REST	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (5 PARATHAS)

Med
DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowls
- Rolling pin
- Heavy tava or cast-iron skillet
- Basting brush or spoon for ghee

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Dough and filling can each be made ahead and refrigerated separately for a day, assembled fresh before cooking. Cooked parathas keep at room temperature for a few hours or refrigerated for 2 days — reheat on a dry tava with a little extra ghee to restore softness and crispness.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Whole wheat flour (atta)	2 cups	250 g	2 katori
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Oil	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach
Water, as needed	¾ cup approx.	180 ml approx.	¾ katori approx.

For the sattu filling

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Sattu (roasted gram flour)	1 cup	120 g	1 katori
Onion, finely chopped	1 small	80 g	1 small
Green chili, minced	1–2	1–2	1–2
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tsp	5 g	1 chammach
Mango pickle (achaar) with its oil	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Ajwain (carom seeds)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Nigella seeds (kalonji)	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Fresh coriander, chopped	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach
Mustard oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the sattu filling (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Water, as needed to bind	2–3 tbsp	30–45 ml	2–3 chammach

For cooking

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Ghee, for cooking	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Sattu is a specific roasted gram flour, distinct from regular besan — look for it labeled specifically as "sattu" at Indian grocers. Mango pickle contributes essential tang; use any good quality Indian mango pickle, or increase the lemon juice if unavailable. This dish uses similar core ingredients to litti chokha, so if you're making both from this collection, consider preparing a larger batch of spiced sattu mixture at once.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

The Dough and the Filling

01 MAKE THE DOUGH

Combine the whole wheat flour and salt, add the oil, and gradually mix in warm water, kneading for 6–8 minutes until smooth and soft. Cover and rest for at least 20 minutes.

02 MIX THE SATTU FILLING

In a bowl, combine the sattu, chopped onion, green chili, ginger-garlic paste, mango pickle, ajwain, nigella seeds, coriander, lemon juice, mustard oil, and salt. Add water gradually until the mixture is crumbly but holds together when pressed.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

The Dough and the Filling, continued



Chef tip. as with litti's filling, keep the sattu mixture crumbly rather than pasty — too much water makes it difficult to stuff without tearing the dough.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The filling should hold its shape loosely when pressed into a ball, without feeling wet or releasing liquid.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Stuffing & Cooking

03 STUFF THE DOUGH

Divide the dough into 5 balls. Flatten each into a small disc, place a generous portion of filling in the center, then gather the edges up and around the filling, pinching to seal completely.

04 ROLL GENTLY

Dust with flour and roll out gently and evenly, using light, even pressure to avoid tearing and exposing the filling, aiming for about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.



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Stuffing & Cooking, continued

05 COOK WITH GHEE

Heat a tava until hot. Cook the paratha for about a minute, then flip and add ghee around the edges. Continue flipping and adding ghee as needed, cooking until both sides are golden-brown with crisp spots, about 4–5 minutes total.

Color indicator. sattu paratha is ready when both sides show deep golden-brown patches and the edges look crisp rather than pale and soft.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Overstuffing the paratha, or rolling too aggressively, are the most common causes of filling bursting through the dough. Use a moderate amount of filling and roll with slow, even, gentle pressure.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with a pat of white butter or ghee, plain yogurt, and extra pickle on the side.
- A filling, practical breakfast or lunch, especially popular during Bihar's hot months for its energy-sustaining qualities.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- Cooked to order and served one at a time straight from the tava, so each person gets theirs piping hot.

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a portable, satisfying breakfast wrap with just yogurt, no plate required.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Filling Right

- A well-seasoned, slightly dry filling is essential for a paratha that rolls smoothly without tearing.
- Mustard oil in the filling itself, not just for cooking, contributes significantly to the dish's authentic flavor.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Both dough and filling can be made the night before and assembled fresh in the morning for a quicker breakfast.
- Stuffed, uncooked parathas freeze well, making this a practical make-ahead breakfast option.

RESTAURANT TRICK

A generous final ghee baste, similar to the ghee-dipping step in litti, gives the paratha extra richness — don't hold back if you want the full traditional flavor.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

290 kcal	10 g	38 g	11 g	6 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Sattu Paratha with Extra Pickle — an especially tangy version favored by some households.

Plain Sattu Filling — a simpler version without onion, for a milder flavor closer to sattu's traditional use.

Sattu Roti — an unstuffed version where sattu is mixed directly into the dough rather than used as a filling.

What's the difference between this and litti?

Both use spiced sattu filling, but sattu paratha is rolled flat and cooked on a tava like a regular stuffed flatbread, while litti is shaped into a ball and roasted whole, traditionally over coals.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make the filling ahead of time?

Yes — it keeps refrigerated for a day, though it's best mixed with lemon juice fresh to preserve its bright flavor.

Is sattu paratha very spicy?

It has warmth from the green chili and pickle but isn't necessarily fiery — adjust both to your preferred heat level.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Sattu	roasted Bengal gram flour, the defining filling ingredient of this dish.
Achaar	Hindi for pickle, used in the filling for tang.
Ajwain	carom seeds, used in the filling for their sharp aroma.
Kalonji	nigella seeds, adding a distinctive pungent note to the filling.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Sattu Paratha

20m ACTIVE PREP	**20m** DOUGH REST
20m COOK TIME	**4** SERVINGS (5 PARATHAS)
Med DIFFICULTY	

DOUGH

Whole wheat flour	250 g
Salt	3 g
Oil	15 ml
Water	180 ml approx.

SATTU FILLING

Sattu	120 g
Onion	80 g
Green chili	1–2
Ginger-garlic paste	5 g
Mango pickle	15 g
Ajwain	1.5 g
Nigella seeds	1 g
Fresh coriander	8 g
Lemon juice	15 ml
Mustard oil	30 ml
Salt	3 g
Water	30–45 ml

FOR COOKING

Ghee	45 g

METHOD

01 **Make the dough.** Combine the whole wheat flour and salt, add the oil, and gradually mix in warm water, kneading for 6–8 minutes until smooth and soft.

02 **Mix the sattu filling.** In a bowl, combine the sattu, chopped onion, green chili, ginger-garlic paste, mango pickle, ajwain, nigella seeds, coriander, lemon juice, mustard oil, and salt.

03 **Stuff the dough.** Divide the dough into 5 balls.

04 **Roll gently.** Dust with flour and roll out gently and evenly, using light, even pressure to avoid tearing and exposing the filling, aiming for about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

05 **Cook with ghee.** Heat a tava until hot.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Whole wheat flour	250 g	☐ Salt	see recipe
☐ Oil	15 ml	☐ Sattu	120 g
☐ Onion	80 g	☐ Green chili	1–2
☐ Ginger-garlic paste	5 g	☐ Mango pickle	15 g
☐ Ajwain	1.5 g	☐ Nigella seeds	1 g
☐ Fresh coriander	8 g	☐ Lemon juice	15 ml
☐ Mustard oil	30 ml	☐ Ghee	45 g

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